

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (11:37 ET)

July 29, 2026 | 11:42 AM ET

15 setups identified | 4 A-Grade | 6 B-Grade | 5 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (4)	B - Strong Setup (6)	C - Watch List (5)
GKOS	HIW	CBZ
CAKE	LAD	CLW
NEO	RCKY	SCL
ASH	QUAD	SGRY
	SLDE	OPCH
	HURN	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	GKOS	Glaukos Corporat	Healthcare Innova	\$158.74	+4.9%	\$9.3B	57M	+32.2	98%	Reporting earnings tod
A	CAKE	The Cheesecake F	Consumer Recovery	\$99.00	+11.2%	\$4.9B	46M	+55.2	100%	Breaking out on consum
A	NEO	NeoGenomics, Inc	Precision Medicin	\$15.70	+19.5%	\$2.0B	118M	+78.8	98%	Explosive volume on on
A	ASH	Ashland Inc.	Specialty Chemica	\$72.09	+6.0%	\$3.3B	41M	+44.2	98%	Just reported earnings
B	HIW	Highwoods Proper	Office REIT Recov	\$35.17	+4.6%	\$4.0B	108M	+47.7	99%	Breaking out on return
B	LAD	Lithia Motors, I	Auto Retail	\$416.86	+16.3%	\$9.5B	20M	+40.0	100%	Reporting earnings tod
B	RCKY	Rocky Brands, In	Consumer Brands	\$49.85	+16.7%	\$0.4B	7M	+34.8	98%	Explosive volume likel
B	QUAD	Quad Graphics, I	Print Services Tu	\$9.46	+12.5%	\$0.5B	30M	+33.2	95%	Breakout likely driven
B	SLDE	Slide Insurance	Insurtech	\$22.59	+5.6%	\$2.6B	56M	+19.2	98%	Reported earnings yest
B	HURN	Huron Consulting	Consulting Servic	\$161.29	+32.9%	\$2.6B	15M	+22.0	86%	Reported earnings yest
C	CBZ	CBIZ, Inc.	Business Services	\$54.56	+16.8%	\$2.9B	47M	+61.0	71%	Reporting earnings tod
C	CLW	Clearwater Paper	Paper & Packaging	\$21.34	+23.9%	\$0.3B	16M	+42.4	75%	Explosive 24% move lik
C	SCL	Stepan Company	Specialty Chemica	\$61.56	+6.1%	\$1.4B	21M	+23.2	90%	Reporting earnings tod
C	SGRY	Surgery Partners	Healthcare Servic	\$16.40	+5.3%	\$2.1B	54M	+14.7	68%	Moving higher ahead of
C	OPCH	Option Care Heal	Home Infusion	\$24.08	+7.1%	\$3.8B	146M	-13.9	65%	Reporting earnings tod

Medical Devices | Theme: Healthcare Innovation | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 1.16 | Vol: 3.57x | RS/SPY: +32.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$158.74
Day Change	+4.90%
Mkt Cap	\$9.32B
Float	57M sh
RS vs SPY	+32.2%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	1.16
Vol vs Avg	3.57x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Reporting earnings today with market anticipating strong guidance on sustained ophthalmic surgical device demand. Forward catalyst: Q3 print (~90d) and potential pipeline updates for next-gen micro-invasive glaucoma surgery (MIGS) devices.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Glaukos develops and commercializes micro-invasive glaucoma surgery (MIGS) devices including the iStent platform, commanding category leadership in the fast-growing minimally invasive ophthalmic surgery market. The company has expanded into corneal health with iLink cross-linking systems, establishing a diversified medical device footprint.

FACTOR & THEME

Rides the aging-demographics and elective-procedure-recovery tailwind, with MIGS becoming standard of care. Healthcare sector leading (+7.3% vs SPY this week) accelerates theme momentum; sector rotation into defensive growth is live.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$158.74 on vol >350% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 3.57x on a 4.9% move is measured institutional accumulation on an earnings day, not retail chase. No insider activity last 90 days, but the textbook VCP coil (base_tight 1.16, best in the entire screen) signals quiet professional absorption ahead of the print.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS TODAY

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Consensus EPS \$0.68, rev \$107M. Beat history: 3 of last 4 quarters on EPS, serial revenue beater. Market expecting robust guidance on elective procedure volumes and international expansion traction.

KEY RISK

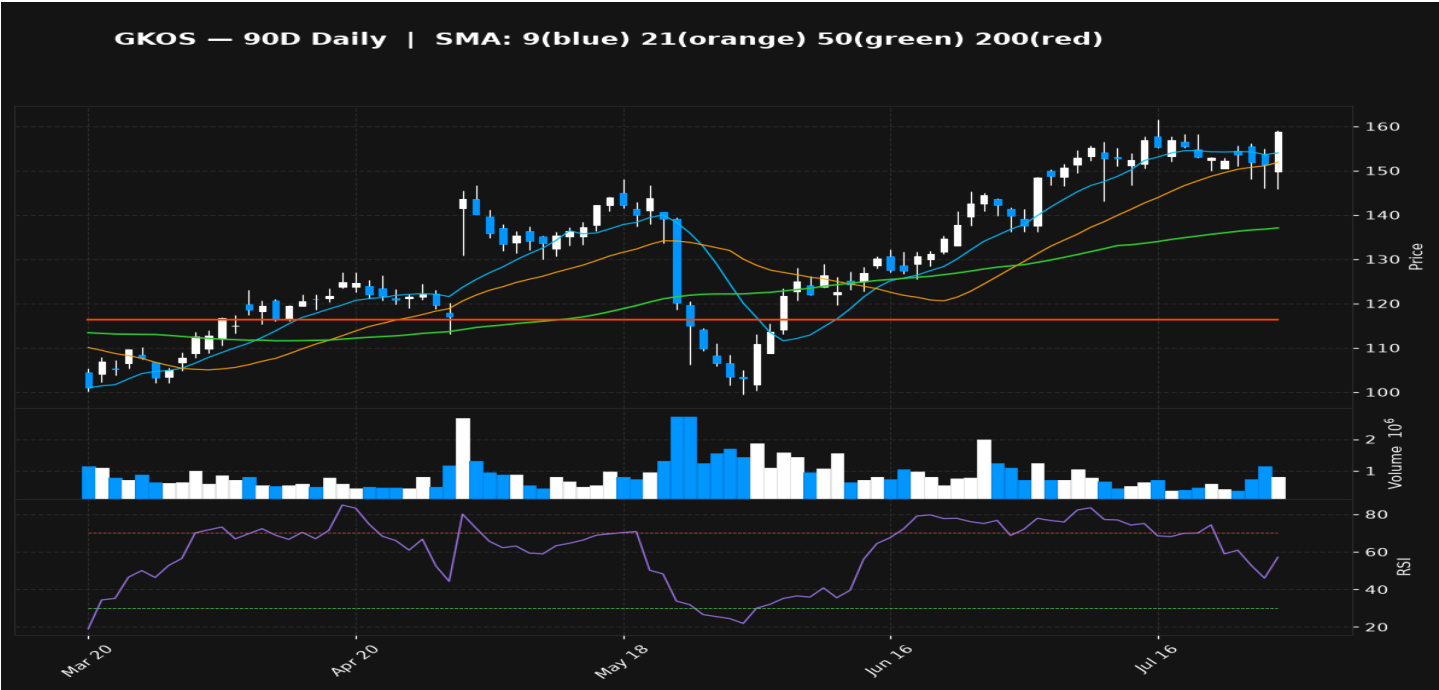
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$150.00 pivot, or on any revenue guidance miss that signals slowdown in U.S. MIGS adoption rates.

ANALYSIS

Textbook VCP setup (base_tight 1.16 is tightest in scan) + RS line new high + Healthcare sector leadership + at 52W high = institutional-quality breakout. Disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY +32.2 is solid but not spectacular, and earnings-day volatility is two-way risk. Mixed regime caps edge, but the technical setup is flawless. Conviction: Medium-High.

Signal: Close above \$158.74 on vol >350% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 3.57x



CAKE

The Cheesecake Factory Incorpor

\$99.00

+11.22%

RS vs SPY: +55.2%

A BREAKOUT

\$4.9B Cap | 46M Float

Restaurants | Theme: Consumer Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 5.33 | Vol: 4.38x | RS/SPY: +55.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$99.00
Day Change	+11.22%
Mkt Cap	\$4.92B
Float	46M sh
RS vs SPY	+55.2%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	5.33
Vol vs Avg	4.38x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)



NEO

NeoGenomics, Inc.

\$15.70

+19.48%

RS vs SPY: +78.8%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.0B Cap | 118M Float

Diagnostics & Research | Theme: Precision Medicine | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 3.54 | Vol: 3.74x | RS/SPY: +78.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$15.70
Day Change	+19.48%
Mkt Cap	\$2.04B
Float	118M sh
RS vs SPY	+78.8%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	3.54
Vol vs Avg	3.74x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Explosive volume on oncology diagnostics demand and likely institutional repositioning ahead of earnings season. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings October 27 will test whether cancer testing volume recovery and Pharma Services segment are sustainably inflecting.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Leading provider of cancer-focused diagnostic testing services and pharma R&D support, processing ~500K tests/year across comprehensive genomic profiling, flow cytometry, and immunohistochemistry. Commands top-tier position in precision oncology diagnostics with hospital and pharma client base.
FACTOR & THEME
Precision medicine and biotech tooling tailwind; oncology testing volumes recovering post-COVID compression. Healthcare sector leadership (+7.3% vs SPY this week) provides macro lift; theme momentum accelerating as pharma R&D budgets expand.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$15.70 on vol >370% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.74x on 19.5% move with RS vs SPY +78.8 (highest in entire screen) is classic growth-fund accumulation. RS line new high + prox_52w 97.5% = institutions are marking this as a sector leader into earnings season. No insider activity, but technical posture is institutional-quality.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Consensus EPS \$0.05, rev \$170M (Q3 estimates). Beat history: 3 of last 4 quarters on revenue, EPS volatile due to restructuring charges. Market expecting Pharma Services inflection and Clinical Services margin expansion.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$14.20 pivot, or on any guidance at the October 27 print that shows Pharma Services demand softening or price compression in Clinical segment.
ANALYSIS
RS vs SPY +78.8 is the strongest relative strength in the entire scan + RS line new high + Healthcare sector leadership + vol >3.5x = clear A-grade breakout. Disconfirming evidence: Float is large at 118M, base_tight 3.54 is wider than ideal, and 90d to earnings leaves a catalyst gap. Mixed regime and lack of near-term catalyst lower conviction despite pristine RS setup. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$15.70 on vol >370% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.74x



ASH

Ashland Inc.

\$72.09

+6.00%

RS vs SPY: +44.2%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.3B Cap | 41M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 2.8 | Vol: 5.79x | RS/SPY: +44.2% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$72.09
Day Change	+6.00%
Mkt Cap	\$3.30B
Float	41M sh
RS vs SPY	+44.2%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	2.8
Vol vs Avg	5.79x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Just reported earnings yesterday (July 28); today's continuation is professional validation of the print. Forward catalyst: Q4 earnings ~90d and any M&A or portfolio optimization announcements as management executes on the specialty-focused strategy.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Ashland is a global specialty chemicals leader in celluloseics, adhesives, and performance additives serving pharmaceuticals, personal care, coatings, and construction. The company divested commodity businesses to focus on high-margin specialty segments with defensible moats.

FACTOR & THEME

Specialty chemicals seeing margin expansion from input-cost normalization and pricing power in pharma-exciptient and personal-care segments. Industrial capex recovery (reshoring tailwind) supports coatings and construction-additives demand.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$72.09 on vol >570% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 5.79x on 6% follow-through after earnings signals institutional validation-not a one-day pop. Base_tight 2.8 + RS line new high + prox_52w 97.8% = textbook post-earnings continuation setup. No insider activity, but the measured accumulation pattern is professional.

EARNINGS

REPORTED

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Reported yesterday (July 28). Consensus likely beaten based on 6% follow-through today; awaiting detailed guidance commentary on margin trajectory and end-market demand (pharma excipients, personal care, coatings).

KEY RISK

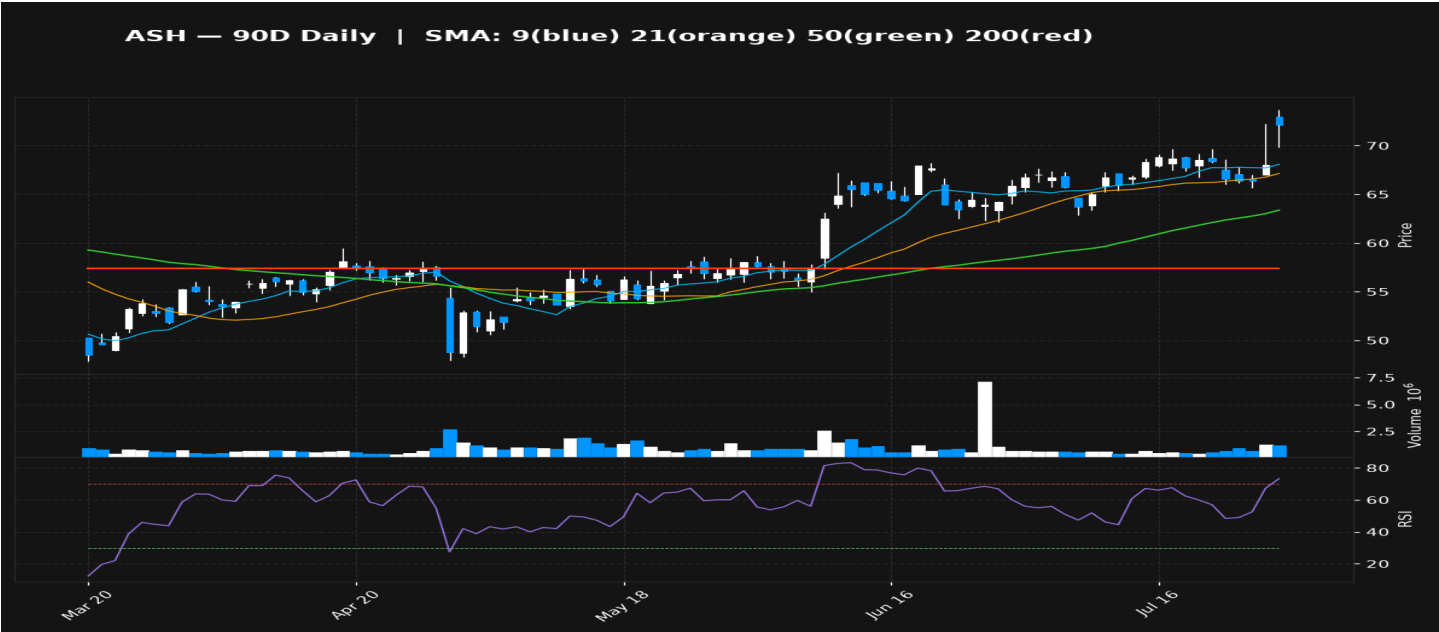
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$68.50, or on any guidance cut in the next quarterly update that signals pharma-exciptient demand softening or pricing erosion.

ANALYSIS

Post-earnings continuation with vol >5x + RS line new high + base_tight 2.8 (tight VCP) + at 52W high = four of five A-grade criteria met. Disconfirming evidence: Not in a leading sector this week (Basic Materials is neutral), and mixed regime caps follow-through probability. The tight base and professional volume profile offset macro headwind. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$72.09 on vol >570% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 5.79x



REIT - Office | Theme: Office REIT Recovery | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 3.55 | Vol: 3.1x | RS/SPY: +47.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$35.17
Day Change	+4.56%
Mkt Cap	\$3.95B
Float	108M sh
RS vs SPY	+47.7%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.55
Vol vs Avg	3.1x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis

Catalyst / Today's Driver

Breaking out on return-to-office narrative and likely asset-sale or portfolio-optimization announcement speculation. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings October 27 will test occupancy rates, lease-spread trends, and any disposition activity that validates NAV above current price.

Business & Position

Highwoods owns and operates Class-A office properties across Sunbelt markets (Atlanta, Nashville, Raleigh, Tampa), focusing on best-in-class assets in high-growth secondary metros. Differentiated by Sunbelt exposure and flight-to-quality tenant demand.

Factor & Theme

Office REIT recovery play as return-to-office accelerates in Sunbelt markets with lower obsolescence risk than gateway cities. Defensive-growth rotation supports REITs in mixed regime; corporate lease renewals inflecting positive.

Breakout Signal

Close above \$35.17 on vol >310% of 20d avg

Institutional

Volume 3.1x on 4.6% move with RS line new high + prox_52w 99.3% = institutions are positioning ahead of a re-rating. Large float (107.9M) means this is a liquid institutional vehicle, not a retail pump. No insider activity.

Earnings

Earnings in 90D

Earnings Context

Consensus FFO/share \$0.95, occupancy ~91%. Beat history: consistent FFO beater. Market expecting positive lease spreads and occupancy inflection as corporate tenants commit to quality space in growing Sunbelt markets.

Key Risk

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$33.50, or on any occupancy guidance below 90% at the October 27 print that signals return-to-office stalling.

Analysis

RS line new high + at 52W high + vol >3x = strong breakout structure. Downgraded from A because base_tight 3.55 is wider than ideal, office REITs are contrarian/unloved (risky in mixed regime), and 90d to earnings is a catalyst gap. Disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY +47.7 is solid but not spectacular, and office fundamentals remain debated. Conviction: Low-Medium.

Signal: Close above \$35.17 on vol >310% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 3.1x



LAD

Lithia Motors, Inc.

\$416.86

+16.34%

RS vs SPY: +40.0%

B STRONG SETUP

\$9.5B Cap | 20M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Retail | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 7.07 | Vol: 7.43x | RS/SPY: +40.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$416.86
Day Change	+16.34%
Mkt Cap	\$9.51B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	+40.0%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	7.07
Vol vs Avg	7.43x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)



RCKY

Rocky Brands, Inc.

\$49.85

+16.66%

RS vs SPY: +34.8%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.4B Cap | 7M Float

Footwear & Accessories | Theme: Consumer Brands | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 6.49 | Vol: 7.46x | RS/SPY: +34.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$49.85
Day Change	+16.66%
Mkt Cap	\$0.38B
Float	7M sh
RS vs SPY	+34.8%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	6.49
Vol vs Avg	7.46x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Explosive volume likely driven by contract-win speculation (military, industrial footwear) or inventory-destocking resolution. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings October 27 will test whether wholesale-order growth and direct-to-consumer margin expansion are real.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Rocky Brands designs and markets work, outdoor, and commercial footwear under Rocky, Georgia Boot, Durango, and other labels. Differentiated by B2B relationships with military/industrial customers and a growing DTC channel.

FACTOR & THEME

Blue-collar employment strength and industrial-capex recovery support work-boot demand; reshoring and defense-spending tailwinds boost government contract potential. Consumer staples sector strength (+6.6% vs SPY this week) adjacent.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$49.85 on vol >740% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 7.46x on 16.7% move in a micro-cap (0.38B, 7.1M float) is either a contract announcement leak or a technical squeeze. RS line new high + prox_52w 98.3% = breakout confirmation, but illiquidity risk is high. No insider activity.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 90D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Consensus EPS \$0.85, rev \$130M (Q3 estimates). Beat history: inconsistent. Market likely pricing in wholesale-order inflection and any large contract wins (military, industrial safety).

KEY RISK

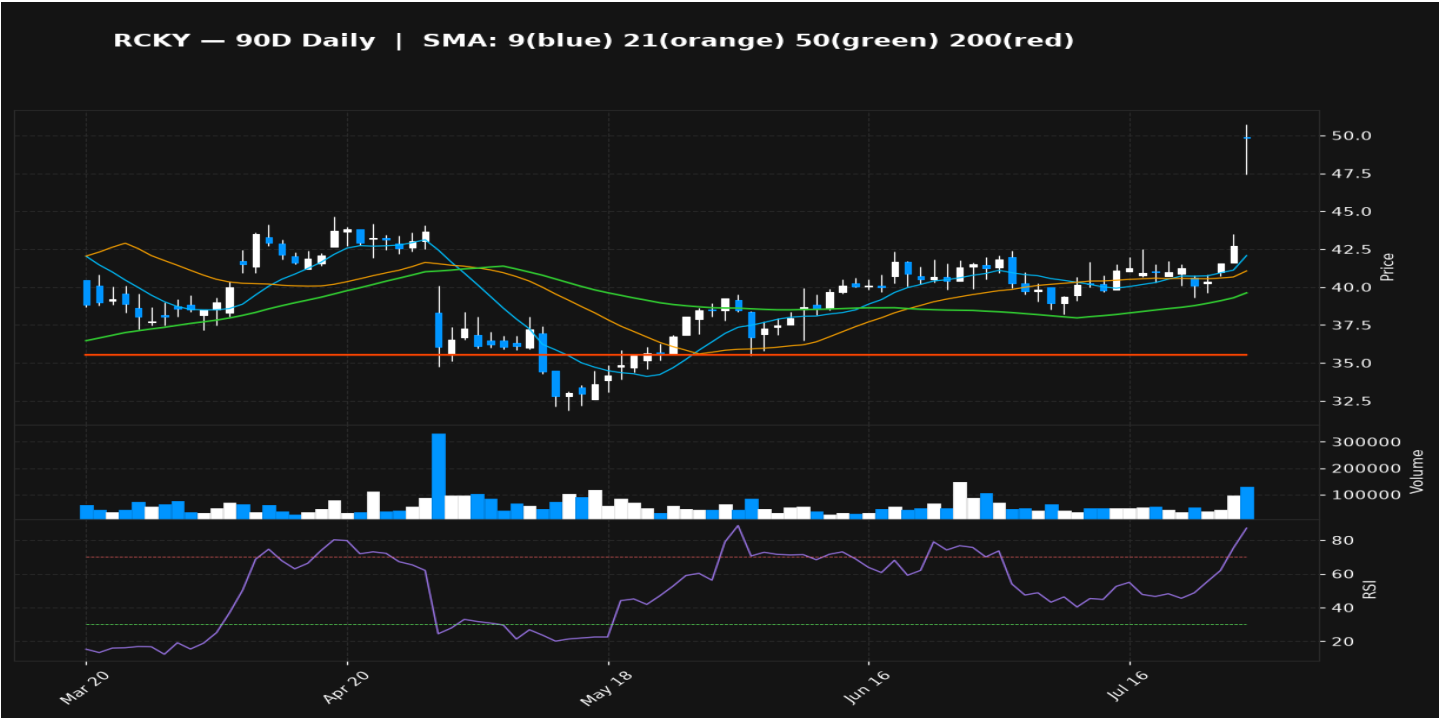
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$45.00, or on any guidance at the October 27 print that shows wholesale orders declining or margin compression from input costs.

ANALYSIS

RS line new high + at 52W high + vol >7x in a micro-cap = explosive breakout structure. Downgraded from A because base_tight 6.49 is wide, RS vs SPY +34.8 is mid-tier, and there is no clear catalyst today-suggests speculation or a leak. Disconfirming evidence: Tiny float (7.1M) means illiquidity risk and gap risk are severe; 90d to earnings is a long catalyst gap. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$49.85 on vol >740% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 7.46x



QUAD

Quad Graphics, Inc

\$9.46

+12.49%

RS vs SPY: +33.2%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.5B Cap | 30M Float

Specialty Business Services | Theme: Print Services Turnaround | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 3.84 | Vol: 9.91x | RS/SPY: +33.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$9.46
Day Change	+12.49%
Mkt Cap	\$0.49B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+33.2%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	3.84
Vol vs Avg	9.91x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Breakout likely driven by cost-restructuring execution and potential M&A speculation in consolidating print industry. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings October 27 will test whether margin expansion and digital-services pivot are materializing.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Quad provides print, marketing, and omnichannel services to retailers, publishers, and direct-mail clients. Legacy print business in secular decline, but the company is pivoting to marketing automation, packaging, and data-driven services.

FACTOR & THEME

Print consolidation and cost-cutting driving margin recovery; potential beneficiary of direct-mail resurgence in political and retail advertising cycles. Industrial services niche with limited growth but improving profitability.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$9.46 on vol >990% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 9.91x on 12.5% move in a micro-cap (0.49B) is significant institutional or activist interest. RS line new high + prox_52w 94.7% = breakout confirmation. No insider activity; could be activist-driven or M&A speculation.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 90D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Consensus EPS \$0.20, rev \$900M (Q3 estimates). Beat history: inconsistent. Market likely pricing in margin expansion from cost cuts and any strategic-review announcements (asset sales, spin-offs).

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$8.50, or on any revenue guide below \$3.6B annually that signals accelerating print-volume declines.

ANALYSIS

RS line new high + vol >9x + prox_52w 94.7% = explosive breakout. Downgraded from A because base_tight 3.84 is wider than ideal, RS vs SPY +33.2 is mid-tier, and print services are secular-decline with limited theme tailwind. Disconfirming evidence: No clear catalyst today, 90d to earnings, and business quality is poor. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$9.46 on vol >990% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 9.91x



Insurance - Property & Casualty | Theme: Insurtech | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 3.29 | Vol: 2.78x | RS/SPY: +19.2% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS		ANALYSIS	
Price	\$22.59	CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER	Reported earnings yesterday (July 28); today's continuation suggests a beat and likely robust guidance on premium growth and loss-ratio improvement. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings ~90d and any geographic-expansion or rate-approval announcements.
Day Change	+5.56%	BUSINESS & POSITION	Slide is a specialty property & casualty insurer focusing on homeowners insurance in catastrophe-exposed markets (Louisiana, Florida), using technology and risk-modeling to underwrite profitably in difficult geographies.
Mkt Cap	\$2.59B	FACTOR & THEME	Insurtech pivot to hard markets and CAT-exposed geographies with improving rate adequacy; reinsurance market stabilizing supports underwriting profitability. Niche player with limited competition in high-risk, high-premium markets.
Float	56M sh	BREAKOUT SIGNAL	Close above \$22.59 on vol >275% of 20d avg
RS vs SPY	+19.2%	INSTITUTIONAL	Volume 2.78x on 5.6% follow-through after earnings is measured institutional validation. RS line new high + prox_52w 98.2% = breakout confirmation. No insider activity; setup is clean but not explosive.
52W Hi Prox	98%	EARNINGS	REPORTED
Base Tight	3.29	EARNINGS CONTEXT	Reported yesterday (July 28). Consensus likely beaten based on 5.6% follow-through; market expecting combined-ratio improvement and premium-growth acceleration in Louisiana/Florida expansion.
Vol vs Avg	2.78x	KEY RISK	Thesis invalid on a close back below \$21.00, or on any catastrophe-loss reserve increase or rate-approval denial that signals underwriting deterioration.
RS Line Hi	YES	ANALYSIS	Post-earnings continuation with RS line new high + at 52W high = solid follow-through setup. Downgraded from A because RS vs SPY +19.2 is weak (bottom quartile of screen), vol 2.78x is modest, and insurtech is niche with limited institutional following. Disconfirming evidence: Mixed regime and CAT-exposure volatility are risks. Conviction: Low-Medium.
Above 50MA	-	Signal: Close above \$22.59 on vol >275% of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 2.78x	
Fwd P/E	-		
Short %	-		
Days to Cover	-		
Inst. Own	-(data lag)		



HURN

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

\$161.29

+32.89%

RS vs SPY: +22.0%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.6B Cap | 15M Float

Consulting Services | Theme: Consulting Services | 52W Hi: 86% | Base Tight: 8.62 | Vol: 5.31x | RS/SPY: +22.0% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$161.29
Day Change	+32.89%
Mkt Cap	\$2.61B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+22.0%
52W Hi Prox	86%
Base Tight	8.62
Vol vs Avg	5.31x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

